



**University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila**  
**2019-2020 Semestre 1**  
**E-Learning unit**

**English - level 1**

– Lesson 3 –  
**English Nouns**

| Staff pédagogique                              |       |                                      |                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------|-------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
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| Etudiants concernés            |             |                         |            |
|--------------------------------|-------------|-------------------------|------------|
| Institut                       | Département | Année                   | Spécialité |
| -Lettres et Langues étrangères | - Français  | -Français               | Licence 1  |
| -Sciences et Techniques        | -MI- ST     | -MI- ST                 | Licence 1  |
| -Sciences Economique           | -SE         | -Toutes les spécialités | Licence 1  |

## Objectives of lesson 3

- i. To familiarize students with some defining features of English nouns;
- ii. To make students aware of the existence of different categories of nouns; and
- iii. To prepare students to readily recognize a noun when they are presented with a sentence to analyze

### Definition:

A noun is a word that names a person, a place, a thing or an idea. The following are examples:

*Boy, girl, table, chair, honesty, happiness, wisdom, book, etc.*

## Types of Nouns:

### 1. Common nouns:

#### Definition:

A common noun is a name given in common to every person or thing of the same class or kind.

\*Common nouns are words for:

**Things:** *chair, bicycle, television, computer*

**Animals:** *cat, dog, lion, sheep*

**Places:** *university, hotel, school, library, zoo*

**People:** *lawyer, teacher, farmer*

### 2. Proper nouns:

#### Definition:

Proper nouns are names for particular people, places or things. They always begin with a capital letter.

\* Your own name and the names of people are proper nouns, *e.g., Omar, Lisa, Amine, etc.*

\* The names of countries and their people are proper nouns, *e.g., America, American, Algeria, Algerian, etc.*

\* The names of town, cities, buildings, and landmarks are proper nouns, *e.g., the Statue of Liberty, the Great Wall of China, etc.*

\* The days of the week and months are proper nouns, *e.g., Sunday, Monday, January, February, etc.*

\* The names of special events and holidays are proper nouns, *e.g., New Year's Day, Halloween, etc.*

\* The names of mountains, rivers and seas are proper nouns, *e.g., Mount Everest, the Dead Sea, etc.*

### 3. Concrete and abstract noun:

**Concrete noun:** names an object that occupies space or can be recognized by any of the senses; are nouns of entities that you can see, hear, smell, taste or touch. *e.g. building, iron, table, food, perfume, etc.*

**Abstract noun:** names an idea, a quality or a characteristic; nouns that can't be touched or seen. *e.g. honesty, wisdom, intelligence, peace, etc.*

#### **4. Countable and uncountable nouns:**

**Countable nouns:** refer to the names of objects, people, etc. that we can count. And they have their own singular and plural forms, *e.g. a book: books, an apple: apples, etc.*

**Uncountable nouns:** refer to the names of things which we cannot count, *e.g. milk, oil, sugar, gold, honesty, etc.*

#### **5. Singular and plural**

- Nouns can be singular or plural, depending on whether they name one person, place, thing, or idea or more than one.

✚ To form the plural of most nouns, add 's' to the singular form of the noun, e.g. pen: pens; street: streets and so on.

✚ Other plural nouns are formed in different ways:

- For nouns ending in (s, ch, sh, x, or zz) add 'es' to form the plural. (e.g., *bus* ⇒ *buses*, *brush* ⇒ *brushes*, *fox* ⇒ *foxes*, *beach* ⇒ *beaches*, *quiz* ⇒ *quizzes*).
- For nouns ending in 'y' preceded by a consonant, change the 'y' to 'I' and add 'es'.
- Some nouns ending in 'f' or 'fe' just add 's'. Sometimes it is necessary to change the 'f' to a 'v'. In that case, always end the word with 'es' (e.g., *roof* ⇒ *roofs*, *shelf* ⇒ *shelves*).
- Other nouns have irregular plurals (e.g., *woman* ⇒ *women*).
- Some nouns do not change from singular to plural (e.g., *sheep* ⇒ *sheep*).

#### **\*\*The most common irregular noun plurals:**

| SINGULAR   | PLURAL    |
|------------|-----------|
| bacterium  | bacteria  |
| corpus     | corpora   |
| criterion  | criteria  |
| curriculum | curricula |
| datum      | data      |
| genus      | genera    |

|                   |                  |
|-------------------|------------------|
| <b>medium</b>     | <b>media</b>     |
| <b>memorandum</b> | <b>memoranda</b> |
| <b>phenomenon</b> | <b>phenomena</b> |
| <b>stratum</b>    | <b>strata</b>    |
| <b>woman</b>      | <b>women</b>     |

**\*\*NO CHANGE :**

| <b>SINGULAR</b>  | <b>PLURAL</b>    |
|------------------|------------------|
| <b>deer</b>      | <b>deer</b>      |
| <b>fish</b>      | <b>fish</b>      |
| <b>means</b>     | <b>means</b>     |
| <b>offspring</b> | <b>offspring</b> |
| <b>series</b>    | <b>series</b>    |
| <b>sheep</b>     | <b>sheep</b>     |
| <b>species</b>   | <b>species</b>   |

### Activity

*Underline ALL the nouns in these sentences. Give the plural form of each noun you have identified.*

- 1) The child asks for his toy.
- 2) The lady uses a knife to cut a potato and a chilli.
- 3) The man is sure that a mouse bit his foot while he was asleep.
- 4) That goose belongs to his wife.
- 5) My loaf of bread is sufficient to feed the fish
- 6) The farmer has a sheep, a deer, and a rhinoceros on his farm.
- 7) The life of a fly and a mosquito is rather short.

### References

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- 3) Eastwood.J. (1999). Oxford Practice Grammar. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- 4) Murdphy. R. (2012). English Grammar in Use. Cambridge. Cambridge University Press.
- 5) Chalker. S. (1992). A Student's English Grammar. Longman: England.



